

## AI may make nurses more important than doctors. It's about time

**One** of the most effective **prisms** through which to understand how people and societies have changed since the **Palaeolithic** to the **Anthropocene** **is** to **examine** the relationship between tools and people. **Simply put**, humans make machines and machines, in turn, shape them. The last few **centuries** — a **temporal blip** in the species' history — **have witnessed** increasing **degrees** of **abstraction**. **Numbers**, the written word, money (increasingly less **tangible**) and now AI, **are** not just technologies. They shape what and who societies value. With machines able to remember and **analyse** information, and **predict outcomes**, a new set of values is **in the offing**. And for all the **anxiety** around AI, this change might not be all bad.

Demis Hassabis, Nobel **laureate** and CEO and co-founder of Google DeepMind, said that while AI and robotics may be able to replace doctors, especially in diagnosis, it will **likely** be unable to replace nurses. His statement **flags** a broader possibility: **Professions** based on knowledge and **abstract** skills **could** become increasingly **obsolete**, and tangible, emotional **labour** more valuable. AI will not be refilling the gas on the AC compressor any time soon. It will not comfort an **ageing** relative in a meaningful way, nor make sure that a child is loved when both parents are at work. **In essence**, the **jobs** that are often seen as less skilled today **could** well become the most valuable.

**Hierarchies** of labour have been **papered over** in the name of what the market, guided by an **ethereal**, invisible hand, demands. Now, as the most **lucrative professions** of today – doctors, investment bankers, software engineers, lawyers — **face** an **impending existential** crisis, **perhaps** it's time to value others. Not just **economically**, but socially. Teachers, nurses, **nannies** — those who cook in homes and raise other people's children, those whose skills keep homes functioning — AI might create a new **elite**. It's about time.

[Practice Exercise]

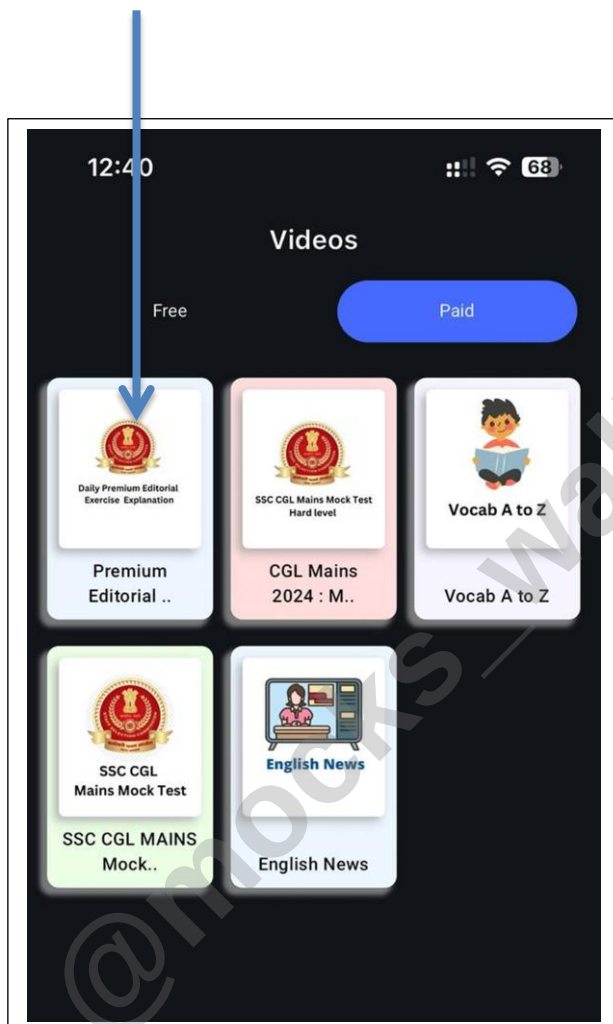
- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

## Vocabulary

1. **Prism** (noun) – lens, viewpoint, angle, perspective, filter दृष्टिकोण
2. **Paleolithic** (noun) – Stone Age, prehistoric age, early human era, ancient era, primitive period पुरापाषाण युग
3. **Anthropocene** (noun) – human age, age of man, modern epoch, current era, human-dominated period मानव युग
4. **Examine** (verb) – inspect, analyze, investigate, assess, study जाँच करना
5. **Simply put** (phrase) – in short, in essence, to summarize, plainly stated, basically सीधे शब्दों में
6. **Temporal** (adjective) – worldly, secular, fleeting, time-related, nonspiritual लौकिक
7. **Blip** (noun) – glitch, anomaly, fluctuation, dip, interruption अस्थायी गड़बड़ी
8. **Witness** (verb) – observe, see, experience, undergo, record देखना
9. **Degree** (noun) – extent, level, measure, scope, magnitude स्तर
10. **Abstraction** (noun) – concept, idea, generality, notion, theory अमूर्तता
11. **Tangible** (adjective) – concrete, physical, touchable, solid, perceptible ठोस / मूर्त
12. **Analyse** (verb) – examine, evaluate, interpret, dissect, scrutinize विश्लेषण करना
13. **Predict** (verb) – forecast, foresee, anticipate, project, prophesy पूर्वानुमान करना
14. **Outcome** (noun) – result, consequence, effect, aftermath, product परिणाम
15. **In the offing** (phrase) – imminent, likely, forthcoming, about to happen, approaching आसन्न
16. **Anxiety** (noun) – worry, nervousness, apprehension, unease, tension चिंता
17. **Laureate** (noun) – award-winner, honouree, medalist, recipient, achiever पुरस्कार विजेता
18. **Likely** (adjective) – probable, expected, possible, anticipated, plausible संभवतः
19. **Flag** (verb) – indicate, signal, highlight, mark, point out संकेत करना
20. **Abstract** (adjective) – theoretical, conceptual, intangible, symbolic, nonliteral अमूर्त
21. **Obsolete** (adjective) – outdated, old-fashioned, archaic, antiquated, passé पुराना / अप्रचलित
22. **Labour** (noun) – work, toil, effort, employment, task श्रम

23. **Ageing** (adjective) – growing old, elderly, senescent, maturing, declining वृद्ध
24. **In essence** (phrase) – basically, fundamentally, essentially, primarily, at heart मूलतः
25. **Hierarchy** (noun) – ranking, order, pecking order, chain of command, structure पदानुक्रम
26. **Paper over** (phrasal verb) – hide, conceal, cover up, gloss over, mask छिपाना
27. **Ethereal** (adjective) – delicate, otherworldly, airy, intangible, heavenly अलौकिक
28. **Lucrative** (adjective) – profitable, rewarding, gainful, fruitful, money-making लाभदायक
29. **Impending** (adjective) – approaching, imminent, looming, upcoming, nearing आसन्न
30. **Existential** (adjective) – philosophical, life-related, crucial, identity-based, human-condition-related अस्तित्व से संबंधित
31. **Perhaps** (adverb) – maybe, possibly, conceivably, probably, perchance शायद
32. **Economically** (adverb) – financially, fiscally, monetarily, in terms of money, budget-wise आर्थिक रूप से
33. **Nanny** (noun) – caretaker, governess, babysitter, child-minder, au pair आया
34. **Elite** (noun) – upper class, privileged, aristocracy, high society, cream अभिजात वर्ग

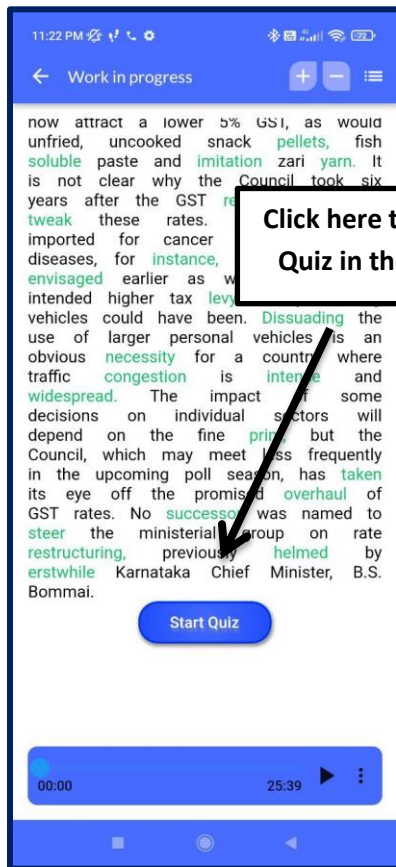
**Video solution of Practice Exercise from this Editorial is exclusively available on App.**



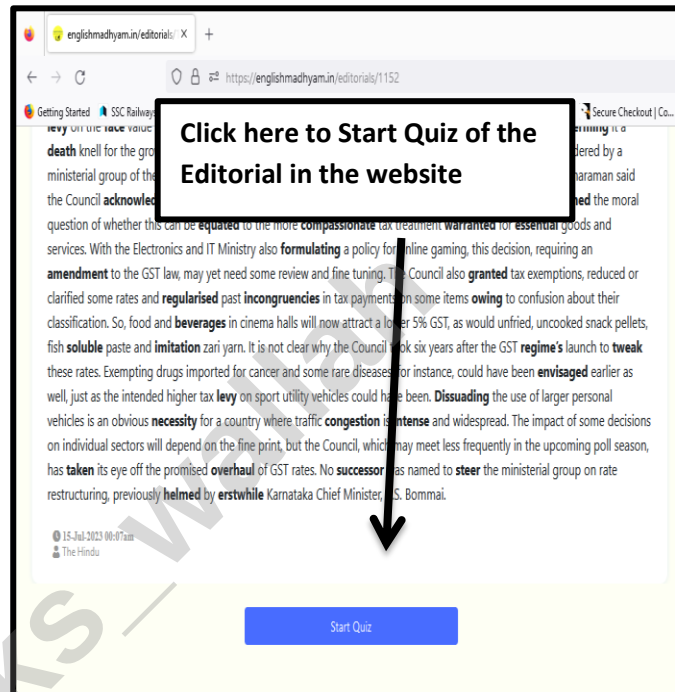
### Summary of the Editorial

1. Tool-human relationship has always defined societal evolution, from the Palaeolithic era to today's Anthropocene age.
2. Technological progress, especially abstractions like numbers, writing, and AI, shapes human values and priorities.
3. AI represents a major paradigm shift, not just technologically, but socially and culturally.
4. As machines gain memory, analysis, and prediction capabilities, the values that guide societies are being reshaped.
5. The rise of AI may not be entirely negative; it could prompt overdue recognition for undervalued professions.
6. Demis Hassabis of Google DeepMind suggests that AI might replace doctors in diagnostic roles but not nurses.
7. This underscores a broader point: abstract, knowledge-based professions could decline in relevance.
8. In contrast, tangible, emotional, and manual labour — often undervalued — may become more essential and respected.
9. AI cannot replace emotional connection or physical caregiving, like comforting elders or nurturing children.
10. Jobs such as AC repair, elder care, and childcare, currently seen as low-skilled, may gain new prominence.
11. Market-driven hierarchies have long undervalued professions crucial to social well-being.
12. Elite roles today — like doctors, lawyers, and software engineers — may face an existential threat from AI.
13. This disruption offers a chance to re-evaluate and uplift roles like teachers, nurses, and domestic workers.
14. The editorial calls for a social and economic realignment, recognizing emotional and care-based labour.
15. Ultimately, AI might elevate the value of human-centric work, creating a new, more inclusive elite — and it's long overdue.

## Practice Exercise: Banking Pattern Based



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